TRUST ISSUES

A SPECULATIVE REALITY-COMPETITION SERIES | CREATIVE DEVELOPMENT PORTFOLIO SAMPLE

An ensemble social-strategy game where relationships are evidence, history is a weapon, and even the people running the show cannot agree on whom to trust.

The concept

Inside a castle, alumni from The Challenge and Bachelor/Bachelor Pad collide in a Traitors-inspired competition. Contestants compete for protection, interrogate each other at the Round Table, and try to expose hidden saboteurs before the final prize is claimed. Familiar alliances become liabilities: a vote may reflect strategy, jealousy, old grievances—or genuine insight.

The creative hook

The game rewards reading people. Its players are famous, within their own reality-TV worlds, for believing they already know one another. The central question is whether shared history sharpens judgment or distorts it.

Tone and audience

Sharp, self-aware, high-stakes reality satire: franchise rivalries, social deduction, confessionals, and a production booth that gradually becomes a second ensemble. Intended as a writing and format-development demonstration, not a claim of production attachment.

What this sample demonstrates

Multi-threaded ensemble plotting • competition-format logic • payoff planting • character-based comedy • confessional voice • cross-episode continuity.

CREATIVE / RIGHTS NOTE • Unofficial speculative crossover using recognizable television personalities and franchise conventions. No affiliation, permissions, casting consent, or production rights are implied.

01 | The game engine

A familiar game with unfamiliar layers

Twenty-five contestants begin: 21 original Challenge Faithfuls, three visible-turret Traitors, and a fourth, separate Secret Traitor. Challenges produce shields or strategic advantages. Round Tables banish suspected Traitors; murders happen off-camera overnight. Banishments generally prompt replacement players, steadily changing the franchise balance.

Three overlapping sources of uncertainty

VISIBLE TURRET • A working Traitor team selects murders and manages suspicion. Its membership changes through recruitment, banishment, and even internal expulsion.

SECRET SELECTOR • Trista Sutter, unknown to the turret, submits a three-person murder shortlist. The turret chooses from it without knowing who set the options. The arrangement eventually passes to Faithful Wes Hayden, who does not know the full machinery.

PHANTOM TRAITOR • Melissa Rycroft joins the murder deliberations after Tori Deal is exposed, but never enters the house or Round Table. She cannot be voted out and earns a share only if the Traitors win.

The format's pressure points

• Shield decisions become public "receipts." A seemingly kind act can implicate its giver several rounds later.
• Franchise loyalty promises safety, but decades of rivalry make bloc voting difficult.
• Replacement contestants arrive with reputations and relationships that rewrite the room's social map.
• The absence of suspicion eventually becomes suspicious: "Why have we not heard your name?"

The second stage: production

Shaun White hosts. Tony Hawk conducts dry exit confessionals. Dave Mirra, TJ Lavin, Johnny Moseley, and Jesse Csincsak serve as the Eyes in the Sky™, interpreting behavior without privileged access to Traitor identities. Michelle Money, the unofficial archivist, tracks the details everyone else misses.

02 | Season architecture

Act I — History enters the castle

The opening “Web” challenge maps past relationships. Early murders remove Derrick, Robin, Kenny, and Alton. Puck, Sarah Rice, Aneesa, and Adam King are banished as Faithfuls. Replacement players shift the balance; CT’s interpretation of old history contributes to Adam’s wrongful banishment. The Traitors quietly remove Katie Doyle from their own ranks and install Vienna Girardi.

Act II — The evidence ages

During the paired Trust Fall, Jamie Chung protects Tori Deal with a shield. It works in the moment and becomes a devastating clue later. Tori is forced to agree to the murder of her ex-husband Brad rather than expose her personal loyalties. Veronica begins connecting the behavioral inconsistencies. Tori becomes the first publicly exposed Traitor; the Phantom mechanism enters the game.

Act III — The game eats its alliances

Trista and Vienna form an alliance while mistakenly believing each other Faithful. As the cast shifts toward Bachelor alumni, the Selector role moves to Wes Hayden. Nick Peterson arrives as a genuine Traitor whose notorious game-player reputation makes his behavior seem almost too obvious to be evidence. The Challenge faction then loses “Franchise Warfare” despite a pledge to vote together: its five members scatter their ballots, and Bachelor votes determine Bananas’s banishment.

Act IV — The receipts win

Jamie’s earlier shield decision catches up with her. The final five are CT, Miz, Jesse Kovacs, Darrell, and Nick. Nick is exposed first; Darrell’s conveniently correct votes become the clue that unmasks him next. Miz, long treated as a punchline and terrified of losing his fictional house, becomes the player who insists on one final round of scrutiny.

Final image

Three Faithfuls remain: The Miz, CT, and Jesse Kovacs. The Traitors lose; the Phantom receives nothing. The recurring comic refrain finally resolves: “The Miz gets to keep his house.”

03 | Ensemble and dramatic payoffs

The Miz — the underestimated observer

Begins as comic relief, with an increasingly frantic concern about his fictional mortgage. Ends as the decisive reader of the room. The comedy does not disappear; it becomes the emotional stakes behind an earned intellectual victory.

CT and Bananas — the franchise fracture

The Challenge veterans understand each other too well—and trust each other too little. Their failed coalition vote illustrates the show's thesis: intimate history is not the same thing as reliable evidence.

Tori — loyalty with a cost

Her shield protection by Jamie becomes a future clue. Her conflicted decision to allow Brad's murder creates authentic grief that must coexist with strategic concealment.

Vienna and Trista — accidental intimacy

Each is secretly a Traitor, yet neither recognizes the other's role. Their bond is built on an incorrect assumption of shared innocence, turning Bachelor history into both shelter and danger.

Nick and Darrell — the final misdirection

Nick's visible ruthlessness provides camouflage; Darrell's quiet longevity provides safety. The final revelation hinges not on who voted correctly, but on when a correct vote became convenient.

Michelle Money — the audience's memory

A supporting analyst becomes the production booth's de facto oracle by noticing patterns, timelines, and tiny contradictions. Her arc rewards attention over spectacle and leads naturally into the reunion tribunal.

The reunion escalation

A "Soapvengers™" panel—Judge Judy, Steve Wilkos, Judge Joe Brown, Montel Williams, and Maury Povich—cross-examines betrayals, voting records, relationship history, and the cast's conflicting explanations. It is part courtroom parody, part forensic recap.

04 | Sample scene: The Archivist

SCREENPLAY ADAPTATION • Based on the established simulation; dialogue and transitions are adapted, not a verbatim transcript.

INT. EYES IN THE SKY — CONTROL BOOTH — NIGHT

Five monitors display the remaining contestants: THE MIZ, DARRELL, JESSE KOVACS, CT, and NICK PETERSON.

JESSE PALMER stands before the finalists, preparing to announce the results of the season's final challenge: How Much Did You Learn?

Upstairs, TJ LAVIN, DAVE MIRRA, JOHNNY MOSELEY, and JESSE CSINCSAK watch the feeds.

MICHELLE MONEY sits nearby, her accumulated notes spread across the desk.

PALMER (ON MONITOR)

First place: The Miz.

Miz celebrates. Darrell finishes second. Kovacs third. CT fourth. Nick fifth.

PALMER (ON MONITOR)

Your placements will determine your advantages at the Final Fire.

The men upstairs study the standings. Michelle studies the men.

MICHELLE

Miz is going to protect CT.

TJ

Why?

MICHELLE

Because Bananas is gone. CT is the only person left whose game he actually understands.

Palmer explains the advantage. On the monitor, Miz protects CT.

Four men in the control booth stare at the screen. Michelle makes another note.

CUT TO:

INT. CASTLE — FINAL FIRE — NIGHT

The five finalists assemble. They have survived the challenges, the murders, the banishments, and one another. Now they must decide whether to end the game.

INTERCUT WITH:

INT. EYES IN THE SKY — CONTROL BOOTH — NIGHT

The discussion downstairs begins.

MICHELLE

Kovacs is going to say there's another Traitor.

JESSE CSINCSAK

Why Kovacs?

MICHELLE

Because Dave was murdered. Stags was murdered. Kasey was murdered. And Nick is still sitting there.

KOVACS (ON MONITOR)

I'm not ending this. There's still a Traitor here.

Jesse Csincsak looks at Michelle.

JESSE CSINCSAK

...Okay.

Nick begins defending himself.

MICHELLE

Nick is going to use Stags.

JOHNNY

How?

MICHELLE

He's going to say Stags accused him, immediately got murdered, and that killing Stags would've been too obvious if Nick were a Traitor.

NICK (ON MONITOR)

If I were a Traitor, murdering Michael right after he wrote my name would've been the stupidest thing I could've done.

Four heads turn toward Michelle. She doesn't look up.

MICHELLE

Darrell votes Nick.

TJ

No.

MICHELLE

Absolutely.

TJ

Why would Darrell vote Nick?

MICHELLE

Because Nick is going home anyway.

A beat.

MICHELLE (CONT'D)

And when Nick reveals Traitor, Darrell gets to say he caught him.

Silence.

CUT TO:

INT. CASTLE — FINAL FIRE — NIGHT

Darrell writes a name. NICK.

CUT TO:

INT. EYES IN THE SKY — CONTROL BOOTH — NIGHT

TJ

...Goddammit.

Nobody laughs immediately. They're too busy watching.

CUT TO:

INT. CASTLE — FINAL FIRE — NIGHT

Nick has been banished. He reveals himself as a TRAITOR. The remaining players erupt.

CUT TO:

INT. EYES IN THE SKY — CONTROL BOOTH — NIGHT

The room comes alive. Darrell's vote has just made him look like a hero.

Michelle closes one page of her notes and opens another.

MICHELLE

Miz won't end it.

DAVE

Why?

MICHELLE

Because Miz just learned Nick was a Traitor. Now he's going back through who Nick protected.

CUT TO:

INT. CASTLE — FINAL FIRE — NIGHT

CT begins discussing whether the game should end. Miz shakes his head.

MIZ

No. There's another one.

CUT TO:

INT. EYES IN THE SKY — CONTROL BOOTH — NIGHT

Dave looks at Michelle.

DAVE

...Damn.

Jesse Csincsak has stopped watching the main monitor. He's watching Michelle.

JESSE CSINCSAK

Okay. What happens next?

Michelle looks at the finalists. She has spent the season recording votes, shields, murders, replacements, alliances, and betrayals. But the answer isn't simply in the records. It's in what the records reveal about the people making the decisions.

MICHELLE

Darrell.

TJ groans. Not because he thinks she's wrong. Because he knows she's right.

CUT TO:

INT. EYES IN THE SKY — CONTROL BOOTH — LATER

The remaining monitors display the final three Faithfuls: THE MIZ, CT, and JESSE KOVACS. The game is over. Michelle has stopped taking notes.

JOHNNY

Have you ever hosted one of these?

MICHELLE

No.

TJ

You want to?

Michelle laughs.

JESSE CSINCSAK

I'm serious. Next challenge.

DAVE

You already know what everyone's going to do.

JOHNNY

Might as well stand down there and tell them.

Jesse Csincsak smiles.

JESSE CSINCSAK

So, just to recap—

TJ

Don't.

JESSE CSINCSAK

Bachelor people took over the votes—

TJ

Jesse.

JESSE CSINCSAK

Palmer took over hosting—

TJ

Jesse.

JESSE CSINCSAK

—and Michelle solved the fucking game.

TJ

I swear to God—

CUT TO:

INT. CONFESSIONAL ROOM — NIGHT

Michelle sits opposite an unseen producer.

PRODUCER (O.S.)

What do you think about being invited to host the next Challenge?

Michelle shrugs.

MICHELLE

Sure.

A beat.

MICHELLE (CONT'D)

But I'm picking the cast.

CUT TO BLACK.

Process and authorship note

This portfolio sample is based on a user-directed fictional simulation involving recognizable reality-TV personalities. The preceding scene adapts documented outcomes and exchanges into screenplay form; connecting action and selected dialogue are newly written. It is not presented as a verbatim transcript. The concept and character arcs were developed iteratively with AI-assisted brainstorming and drafting.